

1976 GENERAL ELECTION CAMPAIGN PLEDGES

LIBERAL DEMOCRATIC PARTY (LDP) 51:76
MIKI, PRESIDENT

1. Political Discipline

We will realize clean politics and "moneyless" elections, and we aim to build an ordered liberal society. We will thoroughly investigate the political and moral responsibility of the Lockheed affair, and, along with strictly enforcing discipline among politicians and political parties, we will establish a strict political ethic that will not permit corruption or immorality. In order to accomplish this, we will carry out the dissolution of factions and the reform of the system of publicly electing the party president, modernize and rationalize the organizational management, and devote ourselves to the practice of fair and clean politics. In order to prevent corruption in politics and administration, we will study the maintenance of the necessary system and other policies.

2. Electoral System

We will adopt a proportional representation system for the "national" constituency and with regard to a few of the regional districts we will adopt measures which will adjust the number of seats according to changes in population, but keeping the total

number of seats the same. We need to devise special measures so that the confrontation among the parties in the Upper House does not increase. Based on the report by the Lower House's Election System Deliberation Council, we will strive to change the election system currently based on individual units to one based on political party units and we will consider a system that will use at the same time small election districts as well as the proportional representation system. To undertake this reform, we will continue discussions among the political parties and work to achieve an agreement. We will strive to strengthen the public management of elections.

3. Domestic Affairs

We will ensure for the fiscal year 1976 real economic growth of about 6 percent, hold down consumer price inflation to about 8 percent, stabilize employment and work to fulfill and improve national life. We will establish the economy on a process of steady economic revival that balances both growth and price stability. We will make reforms of the current situation of education where entrance examinations overemphasize the memorization of facts and cramming and change it so that the curriculum builds character with the appropriate mix of moral, intellectual, and physical training. Most of the nation will live a lifetime and we will thus promote a lifetime welfare plan that aims to realize a society where one can be creatively active with a fulfilled and stable life. We will carry out systemic policies that

will span among other fields the social security system, education, the labor system, housing policy, old age policy, and community policy.

4. Diplomacy and Defense

We will promote close cooperation with the various countries that share our values of liberalism and democracy, and we will especially further our friendship with the U.S., which serves as the basis for the Japan-U.S. Security Treaty. We will strive to conclude at an early date the Japan-China Friendship Treaty. We will work to conclude a Japan-Soviet peace treaty, on the basis that the four islands of Shikotan, Habomai, Etorofu, and Kunashiri be returned to the homeland. Based on the Japan-U.S. security system, we will work to satisfactorily provide for our defense strength in accordance with our national resources and the state of affairs in the country. In particular, we will equip our defense setup, keeping in mind our recent experience with the MIG-25 incident.

JAPAN SOCIALIST PARTY J2:76
NARITA, CHAIRMAN

1. Political Discipline

We will resolve suspicions relating to the Kodama route and the next generation of anti-submarine aircraft, publish the names of the "gray" officials, and reveal the structure of political corruption under conservative rule by making public all the materials relating to the Lockheed affair. By instituting